Aashish Sunar

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Summary

Software engineer with three and a half years building production software, still a little in awe that ones and zeros carried humans to the moon. I care as much about whether software works correctly as about getting it to run: I have written test cases from ambiguous requirements, and reproduced and documented bugs so developers could resolve them.

I approach GIS from the user's side, with two ArcGIS projects built for people who are not GIS specialists, one of them fourth out of 30+ teams at a hackathon, and a disaster alerting service built on NASA's live event feed. The work this role describes, interface testing, troubleshooting, bug documentation, and localization, is close to what I already do, and I want to learn how ArcGIS releases come together from the people who run them.

Technical Skills

GIS & Web GIS: ArcGIS REST Services, ArcGIS Feature Services, ArcGIS web components, Calcite Design System, ESRI GeoAI, proximity and distance analysis, interactive web mapping, geospatial data from public feeds
Testing & Product Quality: test case design from written requirements, UI and end-to-end testing with Playwright, headless browser automation, bug reproduction and reporting, unit and integration testing, accessibility testing (WCAG, ARIA, keyboard navigation), code review
Scripting & Languages: Python (proficient), Java (proficient), C++, C, TypeScript, JavaScript, HTML5/CSS, SQL
Frameworks & Tools: React, Next.js, Node.js, FastAPI, REST API Design, pandas, NumPy, Git, GitHub, GitHub Actions, Docker, CI/CD
Data & AI: PostgreSQL, MySQL, MongoDB, Anthropic and OpenAI APIs, retrieval-augmented generation, AI agents
Ways of Working: user interviews and stakeholder feedback, written documentation and release notes, Agile and Scrum, software development lifecycle

Professional Experience

AI for Humanity Lab, Claremont Graduate University — Claremont, CA
Software Engineer | AI Research Fellow — *September 2025 to Present*

- Lead the organization of the CGU Hackathon, a campus-wide event open to students across the Claremont Colleges, to draw out creativity and ingenuity in problem solving across AI, software engineering, UI/UX, cybersecurity, and GIS, and to grow a campus culture of building, curiosity, and teamwork.
- Research the latest AI releases and published research each quarter and what they mean for human dignity, transparency, and trust, and write them up in plain language for the lab's quarterly AI report, published with the lab's directors, fellows, and volunteers.
- Built a tool in TypeScript and Playwright that checks whether a website's AI disclosure, the notice telling people they are dealing with AI, can actually be seen and noticed. Existing scanners only confirm the text exists somewhere in the page code.

Claremont Graduate University — Claremont, CA
Software Developer | Graduate Assistant — *August 2025 to Present*

- Built the academic advising assistant in Python and FastAPI around the questions advisors field most often, so students get a clear answer on program policy without waiting for office hours. Over 500 questions handled, and roughly 40 percent fewer of them now reach a human advisor.
- Every answer is referenced against the official policy documents before it goes out. Questions those documents do not cover are held back for a conversation with an advisor, so no student acts on a misreading of policy.
- Met with advisors and students to find where answers were falling short, then routed each question by topic to guidance tailored to that area of policy, which is what made answers consistent from one student to the next.

Soka University of America — Aliso Viejo, CA
Full Stack Developer | Office of Alumni Relations Assistant — *August 2024 to July 2025*

- Wrote a real-time disaster alerting service in Python and PostgreSQL that reads NASA's live event feed, measures the distance from each active wildfire, earthquake, or storm to alumni addresses, and notifies any of 2,000+ alumni living near the affected region, so the office can reach them the same day.
- Moved alert thresholds into a settings page staff can adjust themselves, since the first version required me for every change. Added a dashboard that maps active events and affected alumni, which let staff catch misconfigured rules before a false alert went out.
- Tested the tool with office staff who had never used a mapping interface, observed where they struggled, and redesigned the filters and labels around how they actually worked.
- Set up CI/CD with GitHub Actions and environment-scoped credentials, and added a one-hour cache on the NASA feed to cut the repeated external API calls that had been driving up usage.

Nepal Technical Service Butwal, Nepal

Full Stack Engineer *January 2023 to August 2025*

- Replaced the spreadsheets a retail business relied on with a sales, inventory, and accounting platform in React, Next.js, TypeScript, Node, and PostgreSQL, plus a Flutter Android app for the shop floor.
- Localized the platform for the Nepal market rather than adapting a US product with translated labels, integrating three local payment gateways with signature verification on every callback.
- Handled customer support directly: reproduced issues shop owners described over the phone, documented them as steps anyone could follow, and kept older installations working while new versions shipped. That experience shaped how I write software.

Projects

BlueHabit, Accessible Route Planner on ESRI GeoAI

- Fourth place out of 30+ teams at the CGU Ethical AI Hackathon, November 2025, built over a weekend with three teammates.
- Plans walkable routes for wheelchair users and people with vision loss by combining air quality and satellite data on ESRI GeoAI with Claude Sonnet.
- ESRI GeoAI handled most of the analysis. The harder question was what a person who has never used a GIS product needs to see in the result, and what to leave out.

GeoAssist, Natural Language Explorer for ArcGIS Feature Services

- Built a React and TypeScript app that lets users query public ArcGIS Feature Services for hospitals, schools, and cities with a plain English question instead of REST query syntax. Results appear on the map with popups and are highlighted when selected.
- The interface uses Esri's web components and the Calcite Design System rather than legacy widgets, with ARIA live regions, keyboard navigation, light and dark themes, and reduced-motion support, all verified with a screen reader.

Education

Claremont Graduate University Claremont, CA

MS in Information Systems and Technology | AI-Driven Innovation *May 2027*

- Coursework: Software Development, Database Systems, Natural Language Processing, Building Generative AI Apps, Communications and Networking

Soka University of America Aliso Viejo, CA

BA in Economics and Finance *May 2024*

- Coursework: Financial Modeling, Regression Analysis, Business Statistics, Financial Economics